



Orchestrating Graph Database Workloads in Apache Airflow with Apache TinkerPop

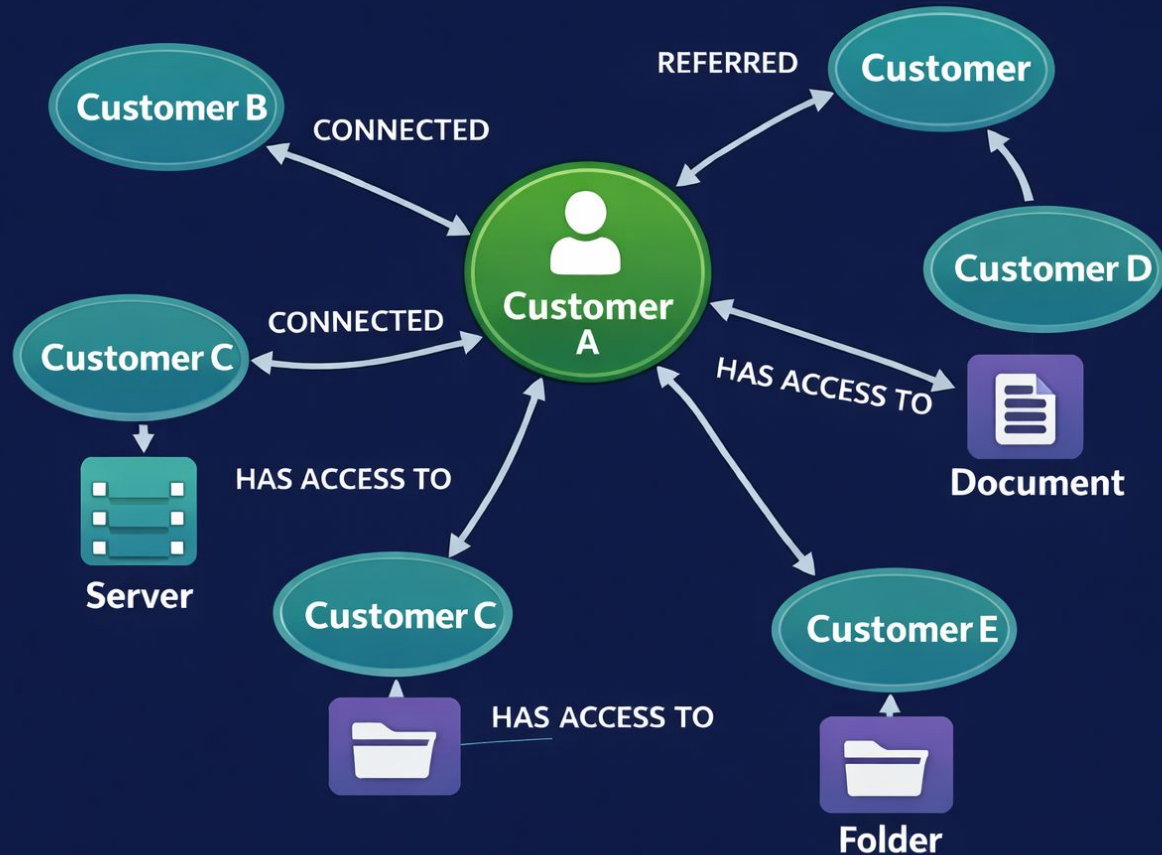


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Why graph databases?

- Relationships
- Vertices (or nodes) & Edges
- Queries are traversal-based, not join
- Fit for:
 - CRM
 - Medical diagnosis
 - Supply-chain
- Knowledge graphs within AI era

CRM Graph Database



What is Apache TinkerPop™?

- Vendor neutral graph framework
- Managed Services
 - AWS Neptune
 - Azure Cosmos DB
- Gremlin traversal language as a query language
- Works with any gremlin server

The Problem in Practice

- CustomHook scripts
- Python Packages dependencies
 - Use @task.virtualenv decorator
- SQL API exist but not fit for purpose

```
class GremlinConnectionHook(BaseHook):
    conn_type = 'gremlin'
    default_port = 443

    def __init__(self, gremlin_conn_id='gremlin_default'):
        self.gremlin_conn_id = gremlin_conn_id

    def _get_conn_id(self):
        conn = BaseHook.get_connection(self.gremlin_conn_id)
        if conn is None:
            raise Exception(f"Connection {self.gremlin_conn_id} not found.")
        return conn
```

```
@task.virtualenv(
    task_id="ingest_gremlin_data",
    requirements=["gremlinpython==3.7.0"],
    system_site_packages=True)
def ingest_gremlin_data(business_date: str):
    try:
        from gremlin_helper import GremlinConnectionHook

        hook = GremlinConnectionHook('GREMLIN')
        query="g.V()"
        result = hook.get_results_df(gremlin_query=query)
```

Why I built this provider?

- Create **out of the box** connector
- Have a production ready hook
- Goal: Make gremlin supported graph databases first-class citizens in Airflow
 - Graph loads & updates
 - Graph analytics
 - Feature generation in AI

Core Components

- Provider building blocks
 - GremlinHook
 - GremlinOperator
 - Airflow Connection Type
- Fully tested – unit & integration testing

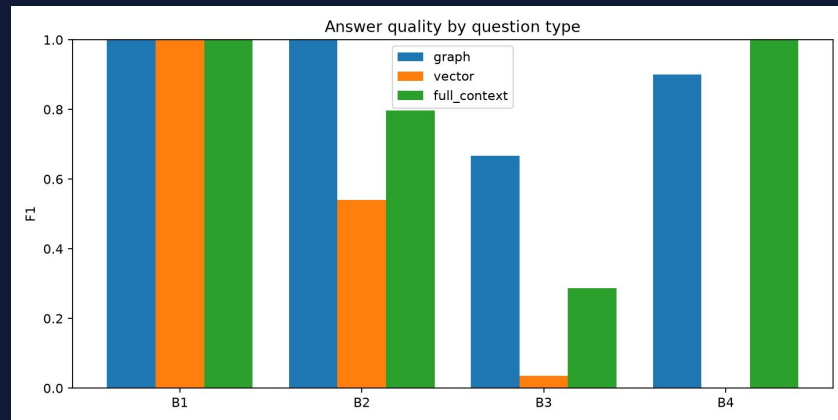
```
@task
def customers_by_tier() -> dict[str, int]:
    """The hook, for when you want to do something with the result.

    ``GremlinHook.run()`` opens the connection, submits, and closes it
    again -- so this is the whole round trip in one line.
    """
    hook = GremlinHook(conn_id=GREMLIN_CONN)
    rows = hook.run("g.V().hasLabel('Customer').groupCount().by('tier')")
```

Demo Overview

1. Act 1 — the provider
 - a. Gremlin_hello
 - b. DAG → Hook → query → results in Airflow
 2. Act 2 — what that unlocks
 - a. 215 support tickets, no schema, no graph
 - b. kg_build @task.llm reads them → 65 relationships → Gremlin
 - c. vector_build same tickets → embeddings → pgvector
 - d. rag_showdown_live one question, both indexes, scored
- One corpus. Two indexes. One orchestrator.

Lessons Learned



- Graph wins multi-hop and aggregation.
 - Vectors win lookup and prose — outright.
 - Hybrid, not either.
- Observability is the biggest win.

What's Next?

- Contributors are welcomed for the following:
 - GremlinOperator has no bindings' parameter at all.
 - GremlinHook.run() closes the client on EVERY call.
 - Driver implementation

```
1  from gremlin_python.driver.driver_remote_connection import DriverRemoteConnection
2  from gremlin_python.process.anonymous_traversal import traversal
3
4  remote_conn = DriverRemoteConnection('ws://localhost:8182/gremlin', 'g')
5
6  g = traversal().withRemote(remote_conn)
7
8  gr = g.V().hasLabel('Customer')
9  print(gr.toList())
10
11 remote_conn.close()
```

Questions?

